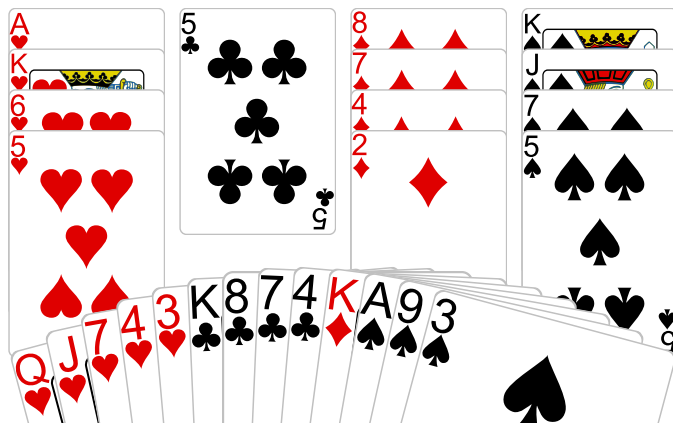


Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3

♥ A 9 8

♦ A J 10 6

♣ Q 10 4



♠ Q J 10 8

♥ Q 10 5 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5

♥ J 7

♦ K Q 8

♣ K J 9 8 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 7 5
 ♥ A K 6 5
 ♦ 8 7 4 2
 ♣ 5

♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ 10

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 10 9 3



♠ A 9 3

♥ Q J 7 4 3

♦ K

♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ A J 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by East

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when East plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if East guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.